LOCAL NEWS

Local tag team, students producing Longmont-centric pro wrestling match

Courtesy Image

Aaron Macomber is pictured as The Vigilante in this screenshot from YouTube.

By KAREN ANTONACCI

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If you go

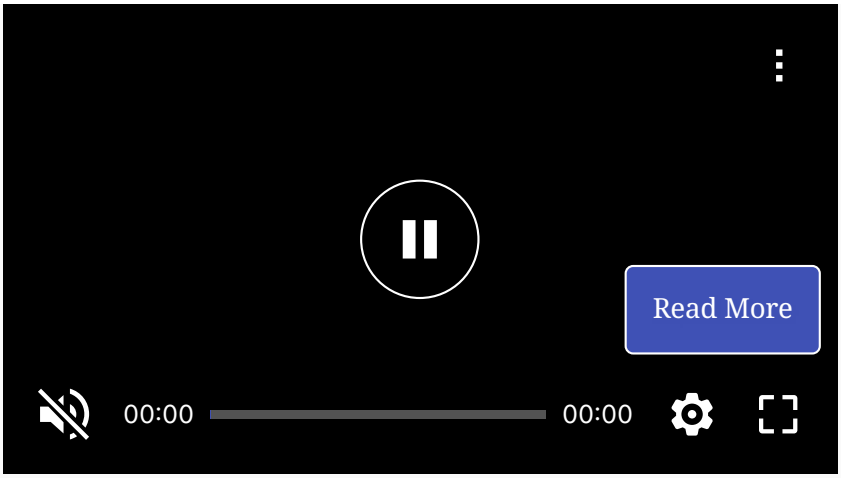
What: LoCo Pro Wrestling Show

When: Doors at 6:30 p.m. Wednesday; bell at 7 p.m.

Where: Second floor of Dickens Opera House, 300 Main St.

Cost: $10 at the door

More info: Locopro.pw



The showdown between The Rising and The Pillars of Mayhem will go down Wednesday night at the Dickens Opera House in Longmont.

The two rival groups will wrestle and the promoter of the show is hoping that at least 200 people will show up to watch.

Thom Ingram is a Longmont high school teacher and he fell in love with professional wrestling at a young age.

“I have been a pro wrestling fan since before Hulk Hogan was a known entity. I grew up in the 80s and I watched the original GLOW (Gorgeous Ladies of Wrestling),” he said.

Ingram became friends with Aaron Macomber when they worked at the Apple Store and the two bonded when they found out that they both were wrestling fans.

“We started going to this place in Denver called Primo’s Pro Wrestling,” Ingram said. “We started going and sitting in the front row and clapping and cheering and following them on Facebook. Then one day, the promoter of Primo’s said if anyone ever wanted to train, he was offering a free class. At the end of the free class, we were both like, ‘We gotta get into this.'”

And so with Macomber in his 30s and Ingram in his 40s, the two friends became the tag-team wrestling duo Cosmos and Chronos, masters of SpaceTime.

“People are like, ‘Why did you start this in your 40s?’ And I always say, ‘Because it would be ridiculous to start it in your 50s, obviously,'” Ingram joked.

But something still irked the tag-team pair about professional wrestling — there was nothing closer to home in Longmont.

So Ingram decided to put on a one-time pro wrestling show tailored specifically for Longmont. He recruited teens he knew from his day job into the ragtag club, which is completely separate from the school district.

Ingram and the teens came up with the Longmont-inspired backstory. A group of hardworking heroes, called The Rising, come from the Chicago-Colorado Colony on a search for prosperity and a desire to make a name for themselves.

But! The Pillars of Mayhem arrived in Colorado and headed straight to Denver to deal with Gov. Edward McCook. The Pillars promised McCook their support and McCook in turn promised The Pillars land that would become Longmont.

The two groups will meet and battle it out in a match that Ingram promises will be goofy, comedic and appropriate for the whole family.

“There’s Mexican Lucha wrestling and there’s Japanese strong-style wrestling. There’s American, big, muscular, 7-foot-tall guy wrestling and there’s death match and there’s comedy wrestling,” Ingram said. “What I wanted for Longmont was something to appeal to students and families. … I want something super funny and super cartoony.”

Ingram will not be wrestling at the show. He will be running things behind the scenes while Macomber will be wrestling under a different character — The Vigilante.

The teenagers will also be involved in putting on the show, Ingram said.

“The students are going to be our tech crew and there will be students filming it. There will be students who are ring announcers if I can find someone. I want them involved in it as much as I can get them involved,” he said. “If you grow a fan base around something, you want people to be 15 when they start, the same way I was 13 or 14 when I started watching wrestling. Because then, they’re going to love it the rest of their lives … you don’t love anything the way you did when you were a teenager.”

Doors open at 6:30 p.m. Wednesday at the Dickens Opera House, 300 Main St. Tickets are $10 at the door and the show starts at 7 p.m.

Ingram said that the LoCo Pro show is a one-time event, but if it goes well, he would definitely consider putting on regular shows. It’s all about the audience having a great time and the Wednesday show will have spare paper for people to make posters to cheer on their favorite wrestler or diss their most-hated heel.

“What’s going on in the ring is important, but it’s important in the sense that it helps facilitate what’s going on in the stands,” Ingram said. “The idea that a group of 100 or 200 or 1,000 or 10,000 — in WrestleMania’s case, 100,000 — people can get together and essentially share live theater and clap and chant and do all the stuff the audience does is just awesome. Where else can you go where a large group of people are all chanting and performing together? You know, church and wrestling.”

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